Hi, Neighbor!

Silver Creek September 2024 Newsletter

UPCOMING CLUBHOUSE EVENTS:

Sept 4 - Ladies' Bunko Night (Anniversary Edition!)
Dinner at 6:30, Bunko at 7:00
Please bring a prize to share

Sept 9 – Community Potluck Dinner
Everyone invited: 6:00 p.m.
Last Names A-H: please bring a main dish
Last Names I-Q: please bring a side or a salad
Last Names R-Z: please bring a dessert
Bingo to follow dinner

Sept 18 – "Sit n' Chat, Work on That" – 11:00 a.m.
(details below)

Sept 19 – HOA Board Meeting – 6:30

Oct 2 – Ladies' Bunko Night

Oct 7 – Monthly Dinner followed by
Emergency Preparedness Demonstration

SIT n' CHAT, WORK ON THAT

"Sit n' Chat" is an informal monthly gathering where you are invited to bring a project to work on (if you have one), and visit. Participants tend to be female, but everybody's welcome.

This month will feature a mini class: vinyl spooky faces that you can adhere to jars, pumpkins, pails and just about anything.

Faces will vary in design and be 4"-5" in size. The cost will be less than $2 each. Bring your own objects.

For more information, or if you want to do multiple faces, contact Carla Peay (435) 705-4327.

WATER WATCHERS

Please join in a shoutout to **Jan Petersen** and **Jen Pfaff**!

Jan Petersen and Jen Pfaff

They have accepted the invitation of your HOA Board to act as Silver Creek's Sprinker Repair Liaisons.

Even before their official appointment last month, this mother/daughter team has provided a great service to all of us by searching out signs of water system leaks and other irrigation problems in our community that needed attention.

Their intervention has saved the Association (that's *YOU*) thousands of dollars this year in water bills as we have been able to identify and make needed repairs to our water system.

In Silver Creek, your monthly HOA fee covers all water usage both inside and outside your home and in our common areas. Water is one of our biggest expenses and has continued to rise.

Jan and Jen now have board authority to work with our landscape contractor and immediately authorize necessary repairs to your sprinklers.

Please give them your thanks, and contact them as needed:
Jan Peterson (435) 671-0976
Jen Pfaff (865) 207-8418

WE'RE ALL IN THIS TOGETHER

Silver Creek has 162 homes. Very nearly half of them are owned by full-time residents, and the other half are owned by neighbors who occupy their homes part-time.

Empty homes may be subject to greater risk of problems with water, mechanical issues, maintenance, and security.

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Your elected Board—made up of both full-time and part-time residents—is heartened by numerous examples of neighbors looking out for the well-being of each other's homes.

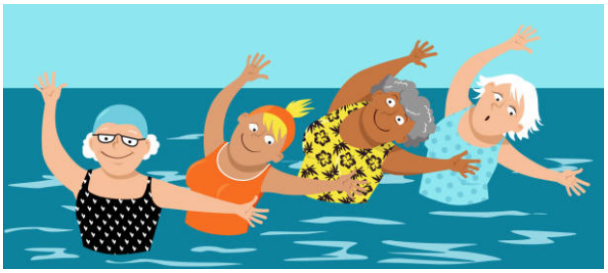
The Board encourages you to make it a point to get to know your neighbors and to be neighborly, whether they are people you see every day or only occasionally.

It's a good idea to share contact information with the neighbors around you.

To say something when you see something is an act of service and friendship.

POOL ADJUSTMENTS IN THE WORKS

Several homeowners have responded to last month's ***Hi, Neighbor!*** explanation of laws that prohibit Adults-Only pool hours, and they have submitted requests and proposals for acceptable workarounds.



Your HOA Board is partnering with those interested owners to find a way to provide equitable times for pool use restricted to specific exercise.

A plan presentation and Board vote is anticipated at the Board's regular September meeting.

INFLATION AND YOUR HOA

Inflation is a general increase in prices and a fall in the purchasing value of money. You can study the economic theories of inflation, but most Silver Creek homeowners surely have lived long enough to understand how it works.

Inflation affects household budgets as prices go up, salaries go up, home values go up and Social Security benefits go up, while the purchasing power of a dollar goes down.

Economists track these related adjustments with tools including the U. S. Labor Department's Consumer Price Index, or CPI.

The CPI shows, for example, that an assortment of goods and services that you could typically buy for one dollar in January ten years ago probably costs about $1.34 today.

Silver Creek HOA fees have not increased nearly as much as overall price levels have in recent years.

To be clear: There is no sentiment to set HOA fees to "keep up with inflation."

The imperative is simply to meet the increased costs the association incurs for such major expenses as landscaping, utilities, maintenance, and insurance—and those costs have kept going up.

Your Board has a fiduciary responsibility to maintain the value of our community and each individual home with a sound financial plan.

The trend lines for revenue and expenses of our Association are not sustainable under our current monthly fee structure.

Association members deserve to know that an increase in monthly HOA fees appears inevitable for 2025.

Please know that your HOA Board is being diligent in its efforts to control every cost it can control and to seek competitive bids for goods and services whenever possible.

It is premature at this point to speculate on any specific increase amount while the Board works toward drafting a budget for 2025.

FAREWELL, NEIGHBORS

Godspeed to **Fred** and **Linda Denison** who have been a part of our Silver Creek community for years.

They are moving into a new place in Hurricane that comes complete with a wood shop where Fred will continue to create beautiful furniture and other designs.

They go with our best wishes for continued happiness and our hope that they will stay in touch.